General rule – travel and exploration · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

When traveling, the group moves at a **pace**: **Fast**, **Normal** or **Slow**. The pace sets distance per minute, hour and day, and its effects on stealth and perception.

Traveling more than **8 hours** a day is a **forced march**: each extra hour requires a Constitution save and may cause Exhaustion.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Fast**: 4 mph but −5 passive Perception.
2. **Normal**: 3 mph.
3. **Slow**: 2 mph, stealth possible.
4. More than 8 h/day: **forced march**, Con save.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the paces with the same distances; forced march and navigation are clarified.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

Terrain and weather aren't in the table. Fix: the DM adjusts the daily distance.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the passing landscape to mark the passage of time.

Step 1 – Choose the pace:

Fast, Normal or Slow. The group travels at the slowest member's pace.

Step 2 – Calculate the distance:

From the table: per hour and per day (8 hours of travel).

Step 3 – Marching order:

Set who leads, who's in the middle and who's behind: it decides who detects and who is targeted.

Step 4 – Forced march:

After 8 hours: Con save DC 10 + 1 per extra hour; fail: Exhaustion.

Step 5 – Navigation and supplies:

A Wisdom (Survival) check to navigate; you also need food and water every day (or a Survival check to find some).

Example: the group walks at Normal pace: 3 mph × 8 h = 24 miles. At Fast pace: 4 mph: 32 miles, but −5 passive Perception.

Pace	Distance / effect
Fast	400 ft/min; 4 mph; 30 miles/day; −5 passive Perception
Normal	300 ft/min; 3 mph; 24 miles/day
Slow	200 ft/min; 2 mph; 18 miles/day; can be stealthy
Forced march	After 8 h: Con save DC 10 + 1 per hour; fail: Exhaustion
Navigation	Wisdom (Survival) check, DC by terrain
Finding food and water (hunting, gathering)	Wisdom (Survival) check, DC 10 (rich terrain) to 20 (poor terrain); success provides food and water for the day

⚠ Common questions:

Who sets the pace?

The group, at the slowest member's pace.

How many hours a day?

8 hours of travel; beyond that, forced march.

Is stealth possible?

Only at Slow pace.

What does a forced march do?

Con save DC 10 + 1 per hour; fail: Exhaustion.

How do I navigate?

A Wisdom (Survival) check.

How do I find food and water on the road?

A Survival check (hunt, gather, look for a spring); the DC depends on how rich the terrain is.

Mounts?

They have their own pace; the group follows the slowest.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Difficult terrain

Does it reduce distance? **Option**: halve it.

Weather

Does rain slow you? **Option**: one pace lower.

Rations

One ration a day? **Option**: keep it.

Rest while traveling

Are Long Rests taken on the move? **Option**: no.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Fast pace

Disadvantage on Stealth and −5 passive Perception.

Slow pace

Allows hiding and stealth while traveling.

Distances

They are given in miles per hour and per day.

Hunting and gathering

Looking for supplies takes time: it isn't travel time.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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